



A ZEROHEIGHT REPORT / MAY 2026

The State of AI in Design Systems.

2026 EDITION / N=123

A year ago, “AI in design systems” was a thought experiment. This year it’s becoming an operating model, but not a settled one. We surveyed 123 design system practitioners, and what came back is a field caught in tension. Teams feel pressure to move faster but have no time to experiment. AI is strengthening the design system team’s position even as fears grow of being bypassed or devalued. Stakeholder expectations are racing ahead of what AI can actually deliver, and the system is being positioned as infrastructure for AI at the same time it’s being routed around. That tension runs through everything that follows: which tools teams are reaching for, where AI is paying back, where it’s quietly eroding their work, and what the rest of the organization is doing without them.

</resources/state-of-ai-in-design-systems/report>

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Eight sections.

01	Who’s in the room	123 practitioners, mostly in-house product design leaders at mid-to-large technology companies.
02	AI is now the default	82% use AI. 61% say usage grew significantly. The question is what to use it for.
03	Where AI pays back	Documentation wins. Design generation disappoints. The satisfaction gap is the story.
04	Documentation is the bottleneck	Only 17% rate docs as ‘very AI-ready.’ 48% already run an MCP server.
05	The shadow AI problem	50% say other teams’ AI use is creating problems. 44% of orgs tolerate it.
06	The organizational picture	25% say ‘no time’ is the top barrier. Budget isn’t the blocker. Time is.
07	How	63% feel favorable. 67% say AI is overhyped. Top concern: output quality.

teams
actually
feel

08

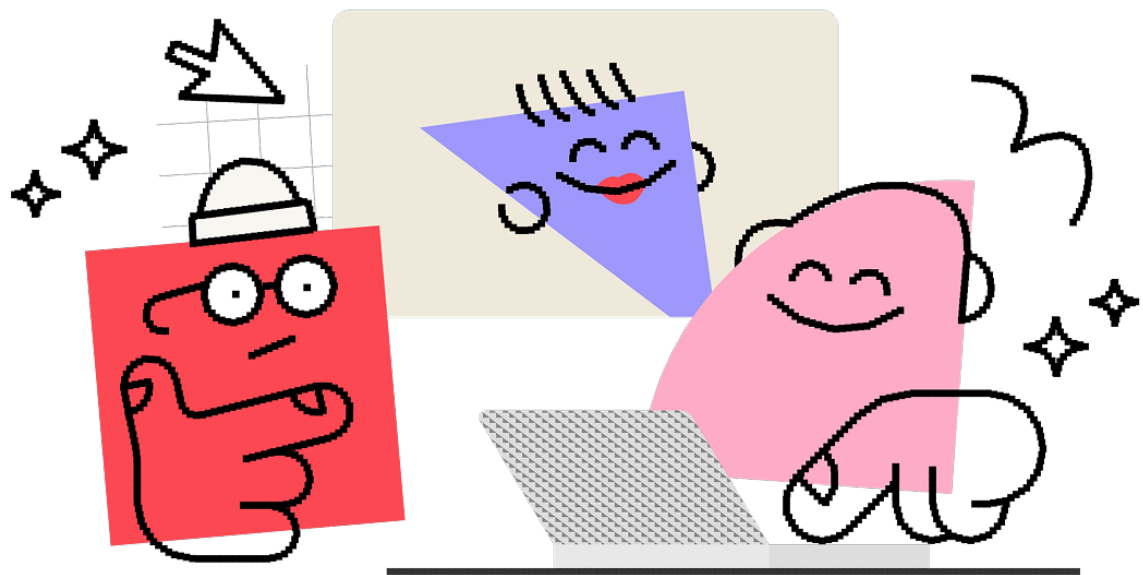
If you're
starting
today

Eight data-backed moves. Documentation first. MCP second. Quality over adoption.

01 /

Who's
in
the
room.

123 design system practitioners, mostly in-house product design leaders at mid-to-large technology companies with established systems. Use this lens to interpret the rest of the data in the report.



ROLES	TEAM TYPE	COPMANY SIZE	DESIGN SYSTEM MODEL
61%	84%	86%	50%
Product Design & UX	In-house teams (not agency)	At companies of 100+ people	Centralized design system team

FIG 1.1

Company size distribution

n=122

Under 10	3%
10-100	11%
100-1,000	30%
1k-5k	25%

44%

at companies under 1,000 people — the “scrappy” cohort in every cross-tab.

56%

5k–10k	5%
10k–15k	4%
15k+	22%

22%

at companies 1,000+ people — including a 22% long tail at enterprise scale.

FIG 1.2**Design system age**

n=121

<1 year	19%
1–2 years	21%
3–5 years	40%
5–10 years	17%
10+ years	3%

60%

of systems are 3+ years old — mature enough to carry tech debt into the AI era.

19%

under 1 year old — systems being built in an AI-first context from day one.

17%

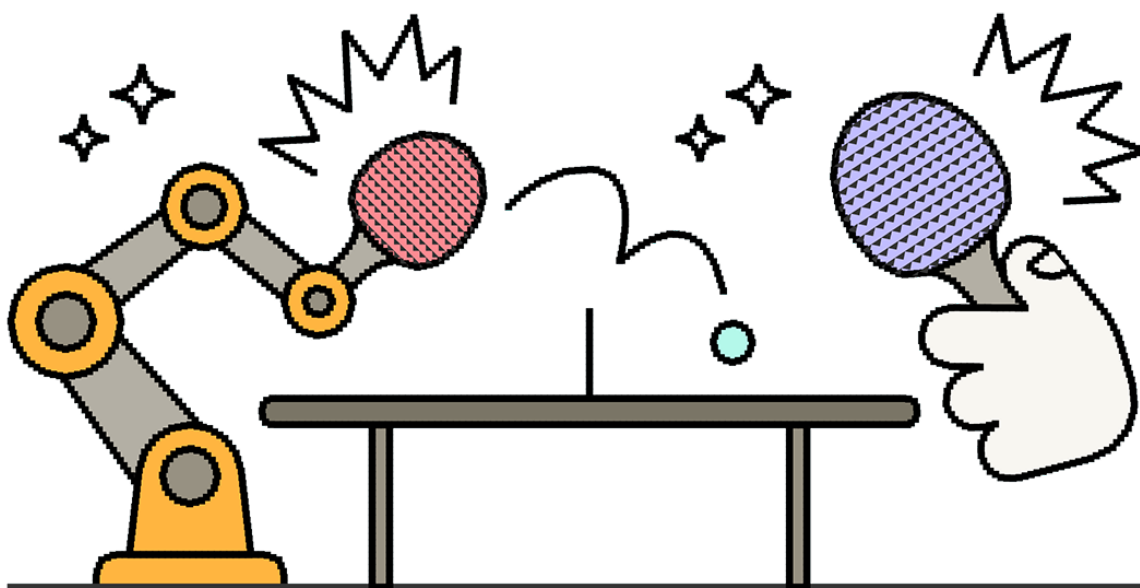
5–10 years old — the legacy cohort with the biggest modernization gap.

A methodology note: this is a self-selected sample. It skews toward designers at mid-to-large technology companies with established systems. Smaller organizations, agencies, and freelancers are underrepresented — read the data as a signal about the state of play, not a census.

02 /

AI is now the default.

82% of teams use AI in some form.
61% of users say usage has grown significantly in the last twelve months. The question is no longer whether to use AI, it's what to use it for.



AI USAGE

82%

Use AI in some form

TOOL USAGE

61%

Increased significantly in the last 12

AI EMBEDDEDNESS

32%

"It's part of our workflow" (not just

DS TEAMS VS
WIDER ORG**68%**

Say they're ahead or on par with other teams

	months	experiments)	with other teams with AI usage
--	--------	--------------	-----------------------------------

FIG 2.1 • CURRENT AI USAGE STATUS • N=122

Most teams are experimenting; a third have fully operationalized.

32%

50%

18%

PART OF WORKFLOW

EXPERIMENTING

NOT USING

Four months on from the last Design Systems Report, we've already seen a significant shift in usage of AI in design systems work. While 50% of teams reported experimenting or using AI, this survey has shown that 82% of teams are now using AI in some form. This entire area is moving incredibly quickly, but are we all keeping up?

FIG 2.2

Tools in use across teams

n=121 · multi-select

Claude	74%
Figma Make	56%
ChatGPT	37%
GitHub Copilot	36%
Gemini	31%
Cursor	29%
Codex	4%
Internally built tools	4%
v0	2%

74%

use Claude — the most-adopted AI tool across the sample, which mirrors reports from the influencer community online.

56%

use Figma Make — the clear #2. However, it's worth pointing out that this is potentially because teams already have licenses, so the barrier to adoption is lower.

2-4

tools in the typical stack — the landscape is wide, not deep. As well as this, we saw lots of tools with single respondents, including Replit, Stitch, Base44, Figma Console MCP, Dessn, Linear and Kiro.

There's a clear difference in tool usage when you compare small and large companies. While Claude is leading the charge across the whole sample, larger orgs are clearly falling back on tools they already have licenses for, such as Figma Make and Microsoft Copilot. Are these the best tools for the job? Maybe, maybe not. Are they the easiest to pick up in larger companies? Clearly.

SIDEBAR · COMPANY SIZE

Different companies, different toolchains.

- Small <1,000
- Large >1,000

Claude	68	82	+14 pp
GitHub Copilot	18	46	+28 pp
Figma Make	5	58	+4 pp
Cursor	22	28	+6 pp

“Begin. Stop reading, analyzing and thinking. Learn by doing is critical with AI.

SURVEY RESPONDENT · ADVICE TO TEAMS

FIG 2.3

Single biggest use-case for AI in design systems work

n=105 · multi-select

Documentation	25%
Development	13%
Tokens work	10%
Tools & Plugins	10%
Prototyping & Ideation	10%
Component creation	9%
Audits, reviews & QA	8%
MCP & Handoff	7%
Synthesis & validation	6%
Content generation	4%
Testing	4%

25%

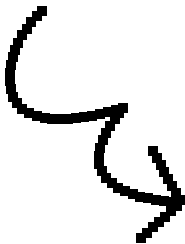
are using AI for documentation creation, including writing component docs, usage guidelines, anatomy, and generating doc drafts.

11%

are using AI to create custom tools and plugins, including internal tools and Figma plugins.

11%

Still haven't found a good use case for AI in their design systems work, as it's too early to tell.

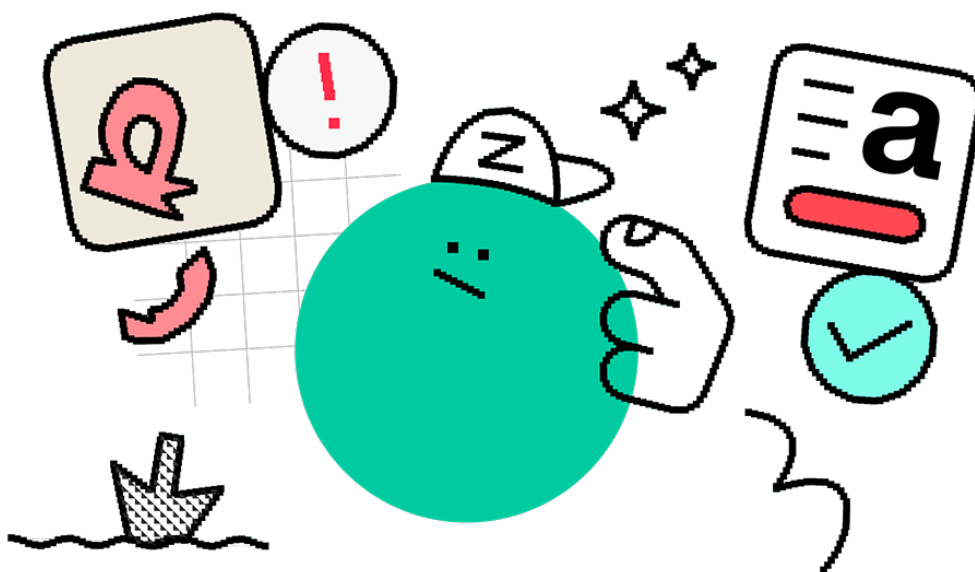


Getting folks to use the tools is the easy part. Similarly, getting them to point the AI at the current pains of design system management makes sense. Nobody wants to write documentation, right? What this doesn't tell us is what teams are actually getting out of all this AI usage, which brings us to the next chapter.

03 /

Where AI pays back.

And where it doesn't... We asked teams to name the two areas they're most satisfied with and the two they're least satisfied with. The top and bottom of the list are unambiguous. but how is this also affecting the work you're doing?

TOP
SATISFACTION

63%

Are satisfied
withBOTTOM
SATISFACTION

67%

Are dissatisfied
with designTIME SPENT ON
CRAFT

65%

Are spending
the same or

RISK OF AI

43%

Don't see AI as a
threat

documentation
generation

generation

more time on
craft

63%

most satisfied
using AI for
writing
documentation

vs

67%

least satisfied
using AI for design
generation

FIG 3.1

Satisfaction by use case

n=122 · % most / least satisfied

Least satisfied	Most satisfied	
Writing documentation	19%	63%
Auditing / reviewing docs	8%	42%
Code generation	25%	38%
Linting & compliance	10%	28%
Component specs	20%	27%
MCP answering questions	14%	15%
Token management	27%	12%
Design generation	67%	14%
Release notes	8%	5%

“ AI flipped documentation from writing to reviewing — half a day per component down to under an hour. And the savings compound: maintainers spend less time writing docs, makers spend less time hunting for answers.

SURVEY RESPONDENT • ON THE POSITIVE IMPACT OF AI

FIG 3.2

Is your team spending more or less time on craft work since adopting AI?

n=118

More time	15%
About the same	54%
Less time	31%

31%

are spending less time on craft work since adopting AI. While the fact that this means 69% are spending the same or more, it's still an early warning signal that we should be aware of. Are we causing our skills as designers and engineers to atrophy?

FIG 3.3

How big a threat do you think AI-driven product development is your team's long-term relevance?

n=121

Existential threat	4%
Significant threat	11%
Minor threat	22%
Not a threat	43%
It's too early to say	20%

43%

see AI as a way to strengthen our position within our organizations. They see it as a competitive advantage to the design system's relevance within the organization.

37%

have already categorized AI as a threat to their relevance. This is a clear indication that our industry is split on the impact of AI on the day-to-day work we do.



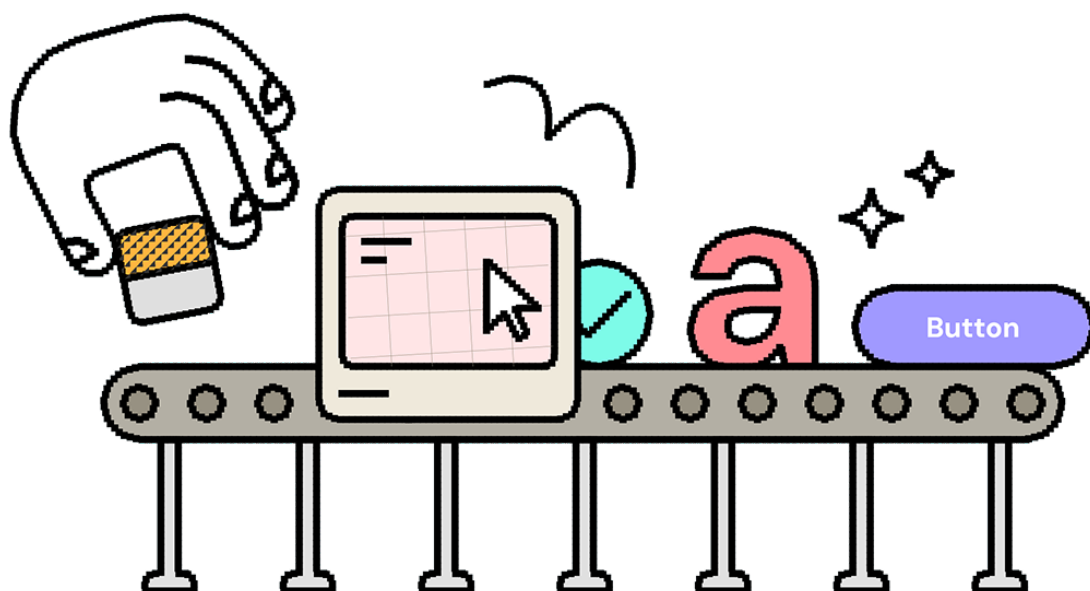


The satisfaction split points to an uncomfortable truth: AI is best at the things teams have traditionally been worst at resourcing. Documentation is the standout win — which is exactly the capability the next section shows most teams aren't ready for.

04 /

Documentation is the bottleneck.

AI is only as good as the material it can consume. Teams with strong docs are compounding wins. Teams without are compounding debt.



MCP ADOPTION	MCP ADOPTION	AI READINESS	MCP USAGE
47% already running an MCP server	31% plan to adopt MCP next	17% rate their docs “very AI-ready”	1-2 different use cases for MCP servers

FIG 4.1 • MCP SERVER USAGE • N=123

Almost half are using MCP servers as a way to ingest information into AI tooling today.

47%

USING MCP SERVERS

31%PLANNING TO USE MCP
SERVERS**22%**NOT USING MCP
SERVERS

USE CASES • MCP IN PRACTICE

What are teams using MCP servers for?

01

Design-to-code translation

Teams point an AI agent at a Figma file and get back component code that uses the right tokens, structure, and DS primitives — collapsing the “redraw this in code” step into a single prompt.

02

Two-way design ↔ code sync

The more advanced setups push and pull between Figma, Storybook, and the codebase — so a change made in code can flow back into the design file, keeping both sides of the pipeline aligned without manual reconciliation.

03

The design system as a source of truth for AI

Custom MCP servers (often built on Zeroheight or Storybook) expose docs, tokens, icons, and accessibility specs directly to agents in the IDE — so generated code is grounded in the actual system rather than generic web patterns.

04

Cutting the design system team’s support load

Teams route component questions through the DS MCP inside the IDE, replacing a chunk of the Slack and ticket back-and-forth that DS teams typically field from product engineers.

05

Visual QA and design-code parity

MCP connections let agents compare what’s in Figma to what’s shipped in code — flagging drift, mismatched tokens, and visual regressions automatically instead of relying on a manual review pass.

06

Stacked MCPs for hand-off

The most mature workflows chain multiple MCPs together — Zeroheight, Code Connect, and GitHub, for example — to pull design context, component mappings, and repo state into a single agent session at the moment of hand-off.

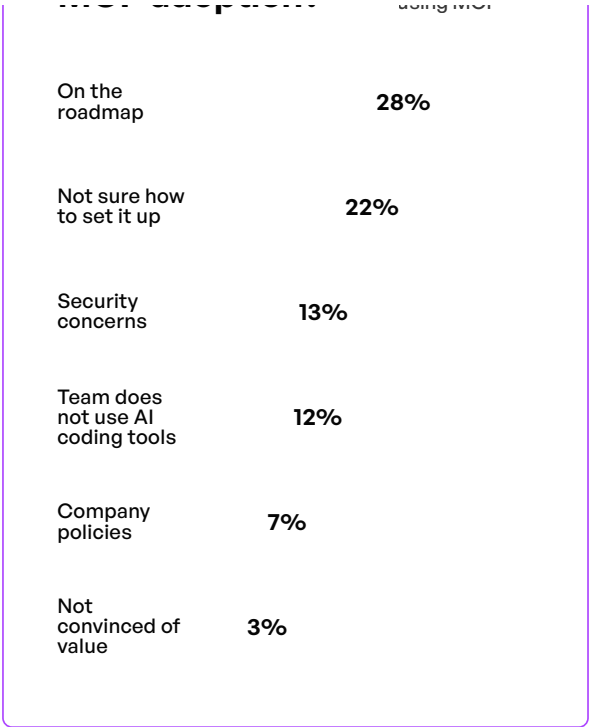
FIG 4.2

What’s blocking MCP adoption?

n=62 • not yet using MCP

50%

of blockers are operational. such as roadmap timing



...or setup confusion, not philosophy.

3%

are unconvinced of the value of using an MCP. The “if” debate is over.

13%

cite security, which is concentrated at large enterprises with review gates.

12%

don’t use AI coding tools at all.

While most teams are using or planning to use MCP servers, one of the biggest problems we've identified is that the success of using MCP servers to help with most tasks hinges on the quality of the documentation. If you put bad in, you'll likely get bad out. However, the landscape of good documentation is still pretty stark.

FIG 4.3 • DOCUMENTATION AI-READINESS • N=122

Only one in six teams describe their docs as “very AI-ready.”

18% 27% 35% 20%

VERY
STRUCTURED

MOSTLY GOOD

INCONSISTENT

NOT ORGANIZED

63%

most satisfied
using AI for
writing
documentation

VS

17%

rate their own
docs as “very AI-
ready”

“**Don’t rush — get your design system documentation right. AI will compound good or compound bad.**”

SURVEY RESPONDENT · ADVICE ON HOW TO GET THE MOST OUT OF AI

The differences between small and large companies are interesting, but not surprising. Large companies are leading on every documentation metric, but not by as much as you'd expect. This also raises some bigger concerns, as the larger your company is, the higher the importance of documentation to ensure everything is aligned and consistent.

SIDEBAR · COMPANY SIZE

Large companies lead on every documentation metric — but not by as much as you’d expect.

Small <1,000

Large >1,000

Using MCP server	40	53	+13 pp
Plan to adopt MCP	26	37	-11 pp
Docs “very AI-ready”	13	20	+7 pp
Docs “not organized”	15	23	-8 pp

FROM ZEROHEIGHT

Make your design system AI-ready without the rebuild.

zeroheight structures your documentation for AI consumption and ships with a production-ready MCP server. Close the 17% gap without changing tools.

See how it works →



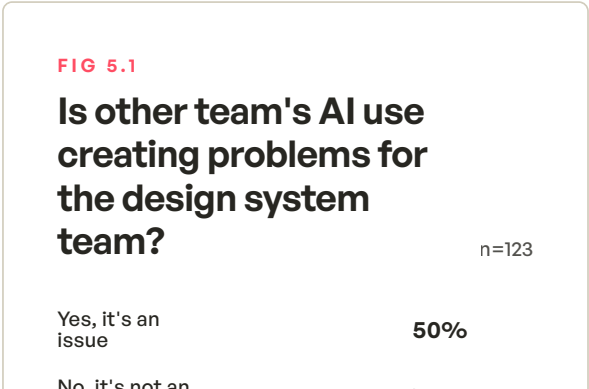
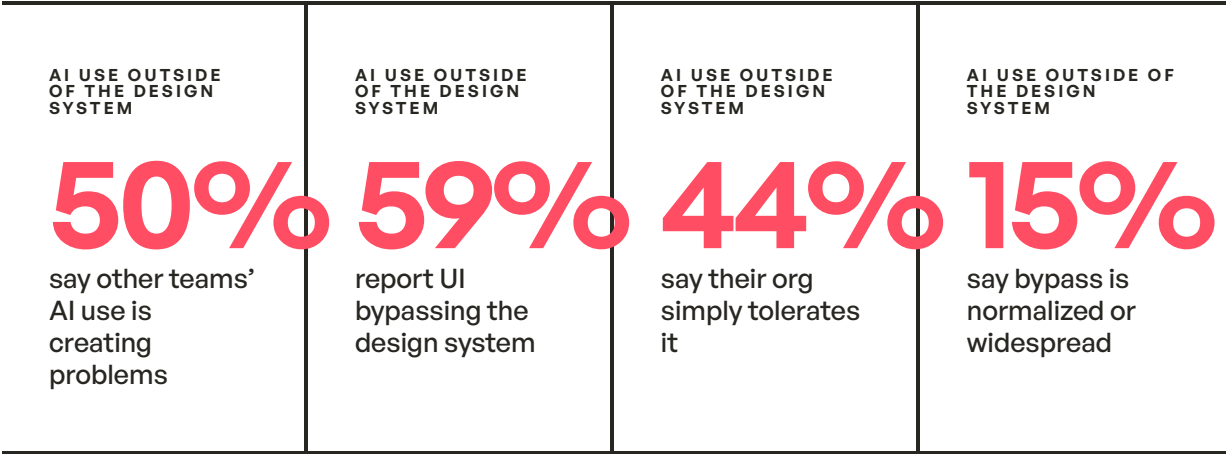
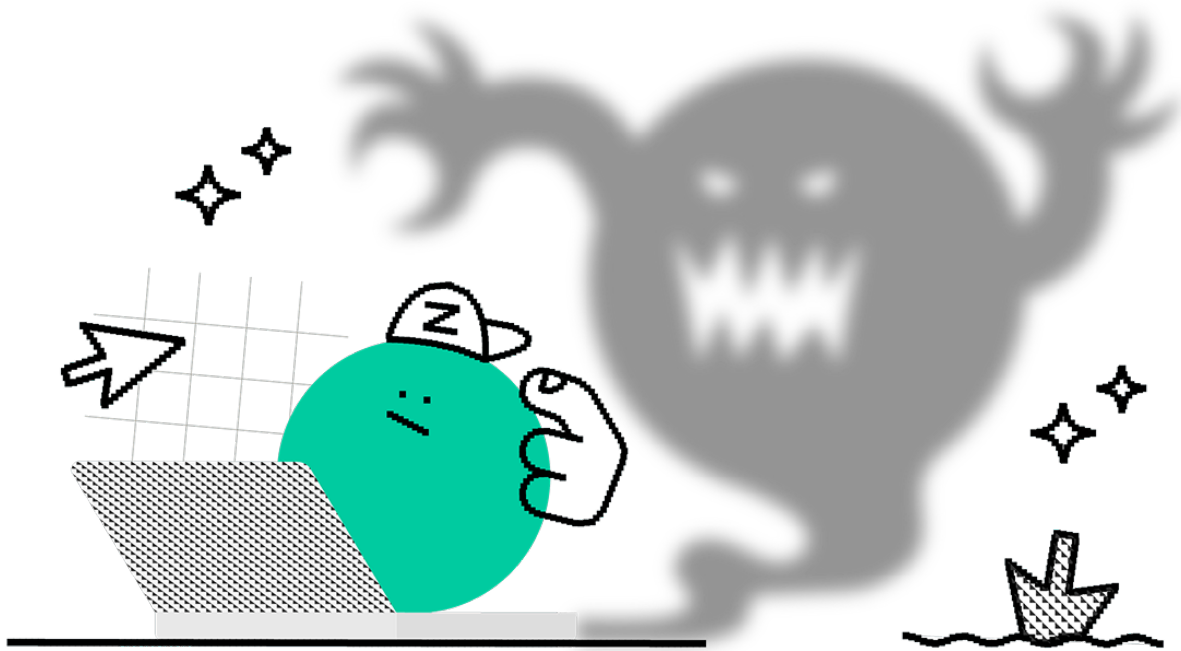


So, what happens when you don't get your documentation right? That's when Shadow AI becomes a massive problem. If you don't have documentation, and the ability to hook that in to AI tools, there is a high chance that the AI tooling will produce artifacts that look similar to your brand, but not actually be compliant with your design system. Enter the shadow AI problem...

05 /

The shadow AI problem.

Half of teams say other parts of the organization are using AI without involving the design system, and it's creating real problems. Not policy problems. UI problems.



50%

of teams are experiencing problems with other teams' creating artifacts that don't align with the design system.

140%

AI-generated UI
issue

34%

We're not
aware of it
happening

16%

100%

aren't even aware of whether this is happening or not.

PROBLEMS · DESIGN SYSTEM BYPASS

What problems does AI-driven design system bypass cause?

01

“Looks like the system, isn’t the system”

AI-generated UI visually resembles the design system but uses hardcoded values instead of tokens, the wrong components, or one-off patterns built from scratch. It’s especially common with tools like Figma Make and Lovable, which default to Tailwind or Radix — leaving users assuming the output is system-compliant when it isn’t.

02

PMs and engineers bypassing design entirely

“Vibe-coded” features, PM-generated UIs, and AI-built prototypes are landing in front of stakeholders — and sometimes in production — without product, design, or DS team involvement.

03

Prototypes that set expectations and never get refit

Once stakeholders sign off on an AI-generated prototype, teams rarely go back and rebuild it on the DS. The un-systematized version becomes the spec, and the system has to chase it.

04

Accessibility being silently

overridden

Even when the DS is referenced, AI frequently strips or rewrites accessibility behavior baked into components — and the changes only surface during downstream review, if they’re caught at all.

05

The DS team can’t police

everything

Teams move faster than reviews can scale, hallucinated components slip through, and the expectation that the DS team will catch every misuse is unrealistic — and quietly devalues the team’s role.

06

Shadow skills and

contradicting AI tooling

Teams are building their own AI skills, prompts, and plugins without DS review — and some pre-packaged skill bundles actively contradict DS guidelines, pulling generated output further from the system.

FIG 5.2 • HOW IS DESIGN SYSTEM BYPASS TREATED? • N=69 WHERE BYPASS EXISTS

Tolerance is the default response.

44%

TOLERATED

23%

NORMALIZED

17%

NOT TALKED
ABOUT

15%

DISCOURAGED

“Product teams use Gemini to generate code. Gemini does not know about our in-house DS and uses other design systems instead. Creating mismatches between Figma designs and code.

SURVEY RESPONDENT

While shadow AI is a problem at any scale, the data shows

that it's more common at enterprise scale. It's a classic design systems problem - the larger the consumer base of the design system, the more likely drift and divergence is going to happen.

SIDEBAR · COMPANY SIZE**At enterprise scale, shadow AI is already a fact of life.**

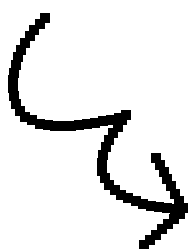
Small <1,000

Large >1,000

Bypass is “widespread”	10	18	+8 pp
Org “tolerates” bypass	36	49	+13 pp
Other teams’ AI causing problems	46	54	+8 pp

“**People create prototypes, and those prototypes create UI expectations with stakeholders.**

SURVEY RESPONDENT · ON WHAT GOES WRONG

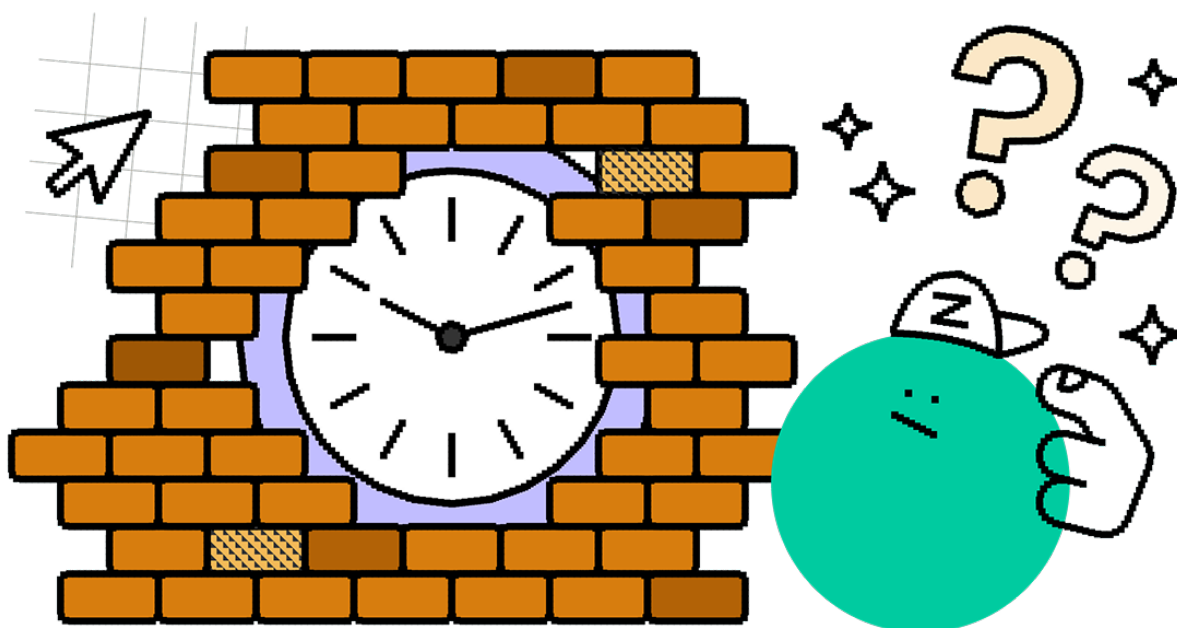


So, leadership is bought in, and budget isn't the blocker. Organizations are mandating the use of AI to make everything speedier and more efficient. However, have teams actually figured out where that time comes from to invest in AI? Which brings us to the organizational picture...

06 /

The organizational picture.

Leadership is mostly supportive. Budgets mostly exist. The single biggest barrier is the thing money can't buy: time.



BARRIERS TO AI ADOPTION

25%

EXPECTATIONS OF LEADERSHIP

39%

AI ADOPTION

56%

IMPACT OF AI

12%

say “no time” is the top barrier	report a gap — leadership expects more than delivered	say the DS team itself drives AI adoption	have experienced AI-driven headcount cuts
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FIG 6.1

Who’s driving AI adoption inside the org?

n=119 • multi-select

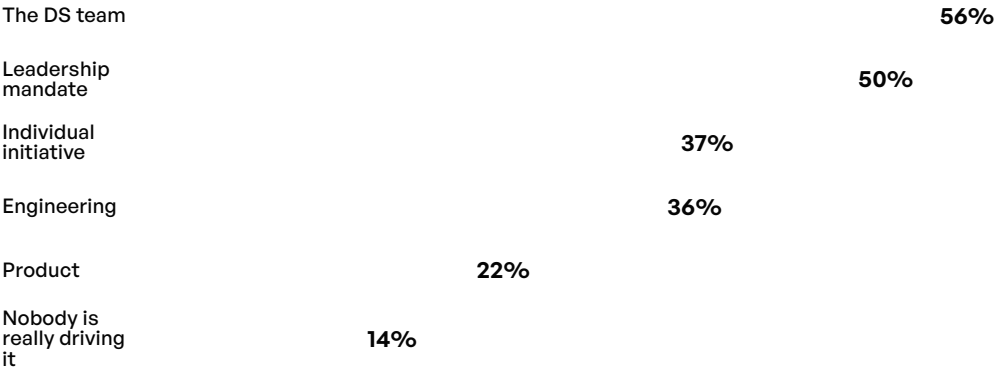


FIG 6.2

Do you have dedicated budget for AI tools and exploration?

n=115

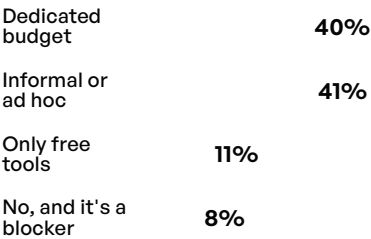
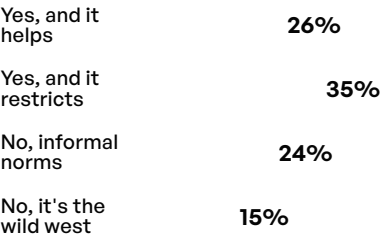


FIG 6.3

Do you have a formal AI policy in place?

n=119



“ AI has elevated the strategic visibility of our team — leadership now sees us as central to how AI interacts with the product's design layer, which has influenced conversations around expanding our remit, redefining our mission, and potentially growing the team to meet that demand.

SURVEY RESPONDENT

FIG 6.4

Top barriers to AI adoption

n=119 · most-cited barrier

No time	25%
Security / policies	17%
Quality concerns	16%
Already doing enough	13%
Not sure where to start	9%
Leadership not prioritizing	7%
No budget	5%

25%

“no time” — the top barrier by a clear margin. Budget, at 5%, is almost a non-issue.

17%

security or policy — concentrated at large enterprises.

16%

quality concerns — consistent with the satisfaction gaps in section 03.

FIG 6.5

AI influencing decisions about your design system

n=116 · multi-select

Reducing team headcount	12%
Increasing team headcount	6%
Securing additional budget	34%
Internal training on AI	43%

12%

of teams have experienced reduced headcount due to AI. On a positive note, this is low, especially considering 6% of teams have experienced an increase in hiring, and 34% have seen increased budgets, mostly for AI tooling.

43%

of teams have secured additional training for AI, as

Dedicated time to explore AI	55%
Changing hiring criteria	20%

well as 55% of teams have dedicated time to explore AI, which shows that our organizations are taking AI seriously and investing in the people to drive it forward.

FIG 6.6

How aligned is leadership's expectations around AI with what your team is actually experiencing?

n=119

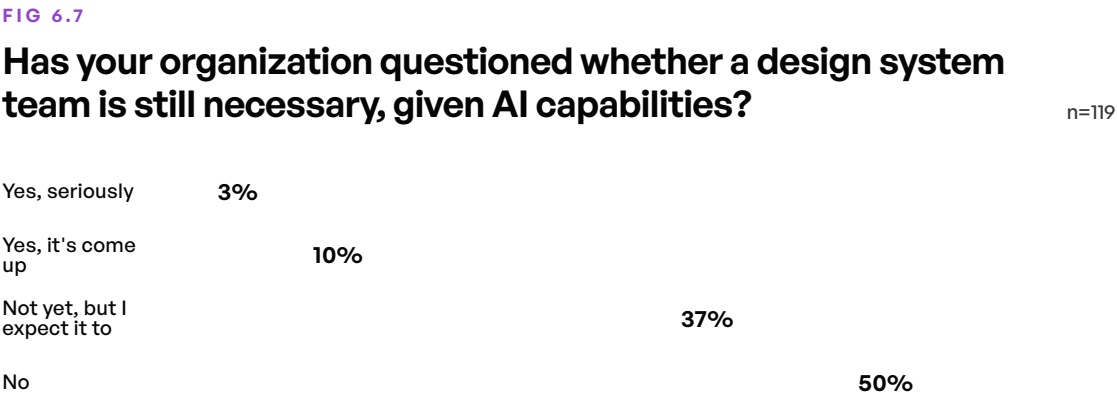
Aligned	50%
They expect more than we can deliver	39%
We are more capable than they expect	7%
AI isn't on their radar	4%

50%

of teams have alignment with leadership's expectations around AI. This is a positive sign!

39%

have the gap that we fear - leadership expects more than we can deliver. There's work to do to close this gap.



SIDEBAR · COMPANY SIZE

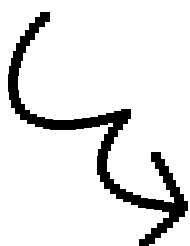
Small companies fight quality. Large companies fight time.

Small <1,000
Large >1,000

“No time” is top barrier	16	33	+17 pp
“No budget” is a blocker	4	12	+8 pp
Quality concerns top barrier	13	20	−7 pp
Leadership mandates AI	46	53	+7 pp
No policy at all (“wild west”)	6	23	−17 pp

“**Start by clearly defining the problems you aim to solve. AI hype should never replace product discovery.**”

SURVEY RESPONDENT



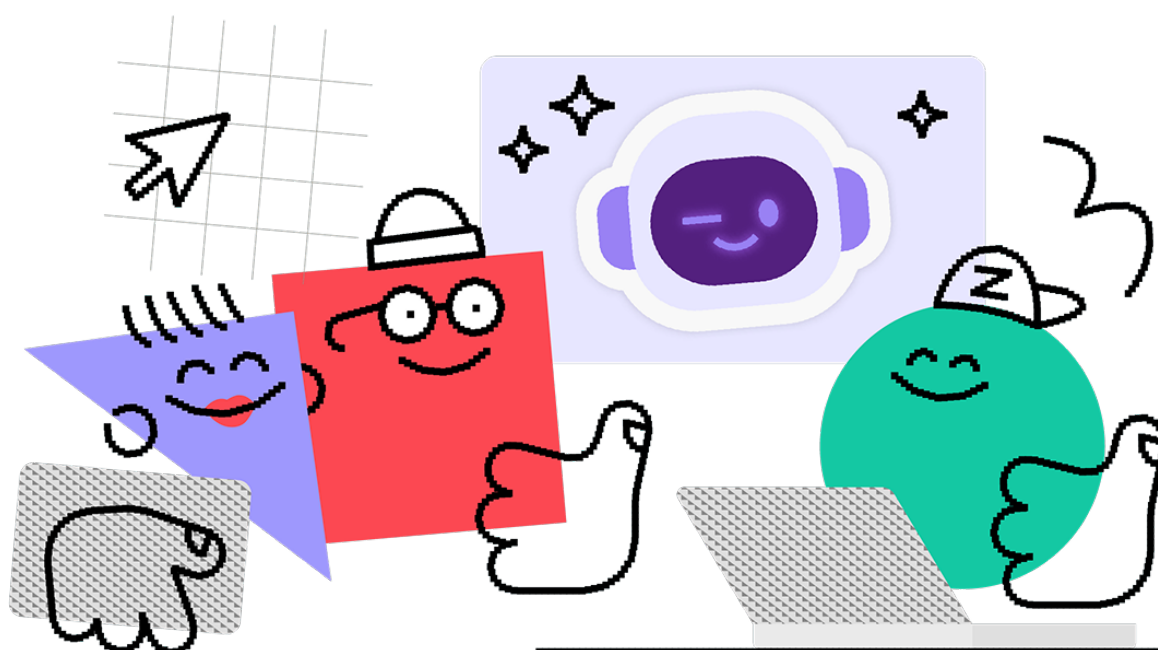
The data says budgets and mandates aren't the blocker. Time is. Which means the question for DS leaders isn't "how do we get resourced?", it's "how do we protect the hours we already have?" Also, while there's concern that AI will affect headcounts, the data shows that this isn't happening yet. There's still time to show the value we can bring to the table, while still incorporating AI into our workflows.

But how do we feel on a personal level?

07 /

How teams actually feel.

The picture is nuanced. Most teams feel favorable about AI, and most teams also think it's overhyped. The top concern isn't job loss. It's output quality.

ATTITUDE
TOWARDS AI**63%**feel favorable
about AIATTITUDE
TOWARDS AI**67%**say AI is
somewhat or
way overhypedATTITUDE
TOWARDS AI**44%**say AI
strengthens the
DS team'sATTITUDE
TOWARDS AI**38%**expect their org
to question the
DS team

position

FIG 7.1

Personally, how favorable are you towards AI in design systems?

n=122

Unfavorable	9%
Neutral	29%
Favorable	62%

FIG 7.2

Do you think AI in design systems is overhyped?

n=120

Overhyped	67%
About right	23%
Underhyped	10%

63%

feel favorable
about AI

AND

67%

also think it's
overhyped

This looks contradictory at first glance, but reflects the reality of the situation we're in. Teams are seeing the benefits laid out by the promise of AI and design systems, but are also pragmatic, especially when looking at expectations from outside the team. It's optimism and skepticism in the same breath, but that's not a bad way to view the situation.

FIG 7.3

Top concerns about AI in design systems

n=123 ·
multi-select

Quality of output	61%
Stakeholder expectations	43%
Over-reliance on AI	37%
Homogenization of design	34%
Deskilling of teams	26%
Data privacy	22%
Environmental impact	22%
Job displacement	22%
Copyright / IP	8%

61%

quality of output — the dominant concern by a wide margin.

43%

stakeholder expectations outpacing what AI can deliver.

22%

job displacement — well down the list, behind quality and homogenization.

38%

expect their org to question the DS team — anticipatory anxiety, not yet reality.

SIDEBAR · COMPANY SIZE

Sentiment is more favorable at scale — even though the pressure is too.

Small <1,000

Large >1,000

Feel “favorable” about AI	56	68	+12 pp
Call AI “way overhyped”	20	27	−7 pp
AI “strengthens DS position”	41	48	−7 pp
Leadership expects more than delivered	36	42	+6 pp

WISHLIST • WHAT WE WANT AI TO DO BETTER

The design system wishlist for what we want AI to do better

01

Use the design system correctly, every time

The biggest gap: AI that reaches for the right components and tokens deterministically, not “most of the time.” Today’s output needs too much manual correction to be trusted unsupervised.

02

Read and interpret existing Figma libraries fluently

Tools like Figma Make still can’t reliably read a well-built library and reuse it — so AI ends up redrawing components and styles rather than referencing what’s already there.

03

Close the round-trip back to Figma

Idea → code via MCPs is starting to work; iterating that code back into Figma for design and documentation isn’t. The loop stays broken, and the design file goes stale.

04

Track adoption and flag inconsistencies at scale

Teams want agents that can crawl an entire application — design or code — and produce a compliance report against DS guidelines, with prioritized fixes. Today, that’s still mostly manual.

05

Less context plumbing, more autonomy

MCPs, skills, rules, markdown context — getting AI to behave on-system takes heavy setup. People want AI that needs less hand-holding and stays consistent without rebuilding the scaffolding for every project.

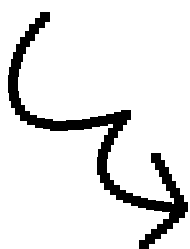
06

Drive adoption beyond the DS team

Several respondents wished AI could actively push product, engineering, and PM teams to use the system — flagging non-compliant work in the moment, suggesting the right component, and making it cheaper to use the DS than to roll their own. Producing assets is one thing; changing other teams’ behavior is the harder, more-wanted job.

“ The biggest gap isn't capability — it's clarity. There's been an explosion of new tools, concepts, and abstractions and the taxonomy is inconsistent across platforms and teams. People are confused about what to use, when, and why. Until the mental model stabilizes and terminology is used consistently, most teams will struggle to get past surface-level AI use. The power is there; the coherence isn't yet.

SURVEY RESPONDENT · ADVICE ON WHAT WE NEED TO DO BETTER



So it seems that teams are cautiously optimistic, clear-eyed, and bracing for the moment the org starts asking hard questions. But what if you've only recently started your journey? Well, the data is clear. Here are eight places you can begin today.

08 /

If you're starting today.

Eight moves the data says will pay back. Each one comes with the evidence from this sample that supports it.



MOVE 01

Start with documentation, not design generation.

Lead with the highest-satisfaction use case. AI writes docs better than it generates components by a wide margin. Ship the win teams can actually feel before chasing the ones they can't.

MOVE 02

Audit your documentation for AI-readiness this quarter.

83% of teams rate their docs as something worse than “very AI-ready.” That’s the ceiling on everything else you want AI to do. Structure, indexing and consistency is the work.

+44 net satisfaction for docs · -53 for design generation

Only 17% describe their docs as very AI-ready · 34% say “somewhat structured but inconsistent”

MOVE 03

MCP is the current future of design systems and AI.

MCP is how your design system shows up inside the tools product and engineering teams already use. The infrastructure conversation is no longer if, it's how. 78% are using or planning to.

48% already using MCP · 30% plan to · 3% unconvinced

MOVE 04

Partner with product teams on addressing shadow AI usage.

50% of teams report shadow AI causing problems. 44% say their org tolerates it. A policy crackdown won't work. Making the design system AI-consumable by default and actual change management does.

59% see UI bypassing the system · 44% say org tolerates it

MOVE 05

Protect exploration time before it becomes a blocker.

Budget and mandate aren't the issue. 25% of teams say “no time” is the top barrier, rising to 33% at companies over 1,000 people. Carve out ring-fenced hours for AI exploration.

25% “no time” is top barrier · 5% cite budget · 55% have dedicated exploration time today

MOVE 06

Set an AI policy, even if it's a light one.

14% of teams have no policy at all, rising to 23% at companies under 1,000. Having a 'wild west' situation is how shadow AI and quality issues compound fastest.

14% no policy · 28% informal norms only

MOVE 07

Make quality the metric before adoption.

61% of teams list output quality as their top concern. Adoption is already near-universal. The work that matters now is the work that lifts quality: linting, auditing, and design system compliance.

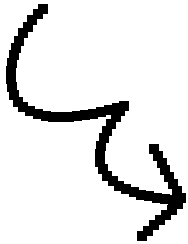
MOVE 08

Get ahead of the stakeholder expectations gap.

43% say stakeholder expectations are outpacing what AI can deliver, and 38% expect their org to question the DS team. Get in front of it: show the wins, name the limits, don't overpromise.

61% quality is the top concern · +18 net satisfaction for linting & compliance

43% expectations gap · 38% expect DS team to be questioned



This is the end of the report, but not the end of the work. If one thing stands out across 123 responses, it's this: the teams winning with AI are the ones who made their design systems legible to it. Documentation, MCP, partnership, policy, time. In that order.

FROM ZEROHEIGHT

The AI-ready design system platform.

zeroheight structures your documentation for AI consumption, ships with a production-ready MCP server, and gives product teams the design system in the tools they're already using. Start where the data says to start.

Talk to us →

